

A safe bet in the world of gambling



Mr. Basile Neiadas.
Chief Executive Officer - OPAP

Three millennia after inventing The Olympics, Greece remains a venturesome nation when it comes to games. With the highest per capita spending on fixed-odds betting and an annual turnover from gaming estimated at over €8.5 billion, Greeks are today considered to be amongst the world's biggest gamblers.

At the forefront of this development is **OPAP**, Europe's biggest betting group by market value and Greece's premier lottery and gaming company. Through heavy investments in R&D and repeatedly successful launches of new games, **OPAP** has consistently outperformed other blue-chip companies on the Athens Stock Exchange since its first part-flotation in 2001. **OPAP**, 34 percent state owned, has exclusive rights to organise sports bets and lotteries in Greece until 2020 and therefore holds a privileged position in a sector which continues to expand with year-on-year growth rates of over 20 percent.

Explains CEO Mr. Basile Neiadas, "Credibility and continuous innovation have been key factors in building our brand and gaining the confidence of local and international investors.

OPAP will continue to make investments in upgrading and enhancing our games portfolio in line with the latest market trends."

OPAP is operating through Greece's largest on-line retail network comprising 5400 agents, and with a portfolio of games including six numerical lottery games (Joker, Lotto, Proto, Extra 5, Super 3, and Kino) and three sports betting games (Stihima, Propo and Propo-goal). Two additional lottery games, Bingo and Super 4, are soon to be introduced.

"**OPAP** invests heavily in research, development and new technologies so that it may redesign its older games and introduce new ones to enhance its games portfolio in line with the latest market trends."

Starting from August this year, **OPAP** has enlisted Intralot in a three year agreement to provide new technology, know how, technical support and services that will reinforce the company's operational capabilities and enable it to offer new betting features and new added value services such as the creation of a players club.

"Our agreement with Intralot will ensure a constant and continuous transfer of know how, upgrading of our technological infrastructure and development of new software. At the same time, **OPAP** has secured the property rights for the new software to be developed and the rights to use 29.400 terminals of the latest technology," says Mr. Neiadas.

According to **OPAP**'s latest announcement of interim financial results for the first six months of 2007, net profits had grown to €285.3 million, corresponding to an increase of 25.1% over the respective period of 2006. "We are very pleased with the increased profitability during the first half of 2007. The strong performance of our two major games Stihima and Kino, together with the additional operational capabilities that were recently ensured, allow us to be very optimistic about the future," commented Mr. Neiadas.

